[INCH-POUND]

A-A-320A
January 16, 1991
SUPERSEDING
A-A-320
February 7, 1980

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
CHALK, MARKING, WHITE (MOLDED)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification SS-C-266 which has been cancelled.

This commercial item description covers molded white marking chalk with a plain or enameled finish.

1. Salient Characteristics

A. The chalk shall produce distinct, uniform and erasable markings when used for writing on commercial chalkboards.

B. The chalk shall be either a cylinder with a diameter of at least 3/8 inch or a tapered rod with a diameter of at least 7/16 inch at one end and at least 3/8 inch at the other end. A tolerance of -1/32 inch is allowed.

C. The chalk shall contain the minimum Calcium Sulfate ($CaSO_4 \cdot H_2O$) content and all other requirements as stated in Section 2 when tested with the appropriate test method.

D. A recognized seal shall be marked on the packaging certifying that the chalk does not contain toxic materials in quantities sufficient to be harmful to the user as a result of any reasonably foreseeable handling or use, including ingestion.

Workmanship. The chalk shall have a smooth, uniform surface, with a soft velvety texture, and shall be composed of material that is free from any defect that may affect its performance or use.

2. Tables

Physical Characteristics (minimum)	Requirement	Test Method
Breaking Strength (minimum)	2 pounds	* - See Below
Length (minimum)	3-1/8 inches	----------
Calcium Sulfate ($CaSO_4 \cdot H_2O$) content	90% by Weight	ASTM C 471

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited

FSC 7510

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*-Breaking Strength Test. Place one piece of chalk across two horizontal parallel rods 1/4 inch in diameter and 2-1/2 inches apart, center to center. Using a 1/4 inch diameter rod, the test load shall be applied in a vertical direction at the midpoint of the chalk. Gradually apply and increase test load up to 2 pounds and maintain maximum load for 30 seconds. The chalk shall be of sufficient hardness to withstand the breaking strength test without breaking.

3. Quality Assurance

Each lot of chalk shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements herein. Sampling for inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the plans specified below.

A. Sampling for visual examination - Inspection Level S-3 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one piece of chalk.

B. Sampling for dimensional examination - Inspection Level S-3 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one piece of chalk.

C. Sampling for end item testing - Inspection Level S-2 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 2.5 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one piece of chalk.

D. Packaging, Packing, and Marking - Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container.

4. Preparation for delivery

Packaging, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

5. Application for copies of technical documents referenced herein:
The issue date in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall be apply.

MIL-STD-105 is available from Standardization Documents Order Desk; Building 4D; 700 Robbins Avenue; Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

ASTM standard test methods can be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials; 1916 Race Street; Philadelphia, PA 19103.

Public Law 94-580, Resource Conservation and Recovery Act, is part of U.S. Code, Title 42. Available from the Congressional Sales Office, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

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6. Regulatory Requirements

The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

7. Ordering Data

Purchasers shall specify packaging, packing, and marking.

No official DOD interest has been registered.

Preparing Activity

GSA/FSS

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